

Food Inflation Forecasting - Feature Importance Report

1. Explainability Approach

Gradient Boosting feature importance was used to identify the variables contributing most to food price predictions.

2. Top Predictive Features

Feature Importance ZAF_FAO_CP_23012 0.169015 BWA_FAO_CP_23012 0.157600
KEN_FAO_CP_23012 0.146199 NAM_FAO_CP_23012 0.111632 FAO_CP_23012_lag3 0.066969
FAO_CP_23013_rolling6 0.051685 NAM_FAO_CP_23013 0.051092 FAO_CP_23013_lag1
0.042364 BWA_FAO_CP_23013 0.036600 ZWE_FAO_CP_23013 0.025096

3. Interpretation

The analysis shows that regional food price indicators, especially neighbouring country indicators, provide strong predictive information. Historical food price behaviour through lag and rolling features also contributes significantly.